



UNDERSTANDING BEDS

Mattress Buying Guide



Rated Excellent ★★★★★ Trustpilot

For free advice call 0161 437 4419

UNDERSTANDING BEDS

Mattress Buying Guide

At John Ryan we are passionate about finding you the highest quality mattress for your budget. This website contains a lifetime of research, hints and tips. Our website is vast, so we have compiled a handy guide for you to download to help you on your mattress buying journey.

It is condensed into five main points with all the hints and tips we have published over the years to enable you to get the best value for your money. It will help you to know what to look for and more importantly what to avoid!



1. Know your mattress upholstery GSM

This is essential and the most important point to grasp - not knowing this is like buying a car without knowing the engine type!

The GSM or Grams per square meter tells you the amount of fibres within your mattress. It's the one thing that retailers also don't want to tell you as it allows you to compare models side by side.

You should be looking for a minimum of 1000GSM of fibres in any mattress. The higher the GSM the more comfort fillings the mattress contains. Our mattresses range from 1000GSM to 5000GSM.

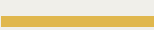
Common mattress fillings are:

Wool	Softer feel
Cotton	Soft feel
Horsetail / Horsehair	Firmer supportive feel
Alpaca / Bamboo	Super soft feel
Coir / Cashmere	Medium / firmer feel
Foams	Firmer feel (Heat retentive)
Polyester	Soft to Medium feel



If a salesperson or manufacturer is either unwilling or unsure about the exact composition of the fillings then run for the hills. If they are proud of the composition of their mattress they will tell you.

Sales people and manufacturers will often try to stretch the truth by saying a mattress contains ‘Natural Fibres’ and then use this wording in their marketing. Did you know a mattress only needs to contain 1% of a fibre to be included on the label?

For example the label could read something like 

This Luxury mattress contains sumptuous layers of natural materials including Cashmere, Wool, Silk, Mohair and Horsehair with premium white Fibres.

Sounds amazing right?

Well hang on, let’s break this down. The mattress in question is a real life example from a high street retailer and actually contains

High Street Mattress Analysis	Percentage Contained	GSM Overall is 1200 gsm
Cashmere	3%	36 GSM
Wool	5%	60 GSM
Silk	2%	24 GSM
Mohair	2%	24 GSM
Horsehair	3%	36 GSM
Premium White Fibre (Polyester)	85%	1020 GSM

Whilst the example above is completely legal, at John Ryan we don’t believe it to be very ethical or fair.

This isn’t even the worst example we found and is representative of a large proportion of retailers. We have many examples where natural fibre contents are below 1%.

For more detailed information follow this link

DETAILED GSM GUIDE

2. Setting your Budget - What to expect for your money

It's essential before you go out looking for a new mattress that you know what to expect for your money. If you have a fixed budget then understanding what you are able to expect for your money will save costly mistakes.



What your money can get you?

How Much To Spend On A Double Mattress	What Can I Expect For My Money?
£500	Will not get you much at best a 13.5 gauge open coil / cage sprung with a thin polyester layer.
£750	Could get you a fairly OK orthopaedic mattress or the beginnings of a basic pocket springs with 800 – 1000 count. No substantial amount of filling other than foams and synthetic materials
£1000	Should get you away from most low-mid ranges and into the basic pocket spring models
£1250	Should get you an average pocket sprung mattress.
£1500	Should get you many manufacturers mid-range models.
£1500 — £2000	Should get you a hand made primarily Natural Fibre Mattress
£2000 +	You should expect 100% Natural Fibres and traditional construction methods
£5000 +	A bespoke hand made sleep system, high end spring units & featuring the Worlds Most Luxurious Natural Fibres

For more detailed information
follow this link

WHAT CAN YOU EXPECT FOR
YOUR MONEY

3. Springs Explained - How many springs do I really need?

One of the biggest sales tactics pushed by retailers is the number of springs in a mattress. Whilst the spring count is important you need to fully understand this in context.

The largest number of pocket springs you can fit in a king size mattress in one layer is 2000 the minimum is 600.

Anything above this will either be a dual layered mattress, usually in high end mattresses, or will feature micro springs. Micro springs have virtually no substantive support in a main mattress and are used to simply up the spring count. You're better off with a single layer of calico encased pocket springs than hundreds of cheaper smaller springs.

In recent years Manufacturers have sadly realised and started to exploit the fact that consumers believe a higher spring count to mean better value and have used some questionable methods to up the spring count. This trend will probably continue, with the main players employing even more outlandish ways to increase spring counts with little or no benefit to the consumer, versus traditional methods of spring construction used by ourselves and the most reputable manufacturers.

There are three main spring types



1. Cage Sprung

This is the cheapest mattress construction method and really should be avoided at all cost. An entry level pocket sprung mattress will be far superior and about the same cost.

2. Synthetic Spun Bond Springs

These are encased in a synthetic casing and glued to each other. Usually found in entry level or mid point mattresses.



3. Calico Encased Pocket Springs

Encased in a breathable Calico cover which are then hand tied/stitched together. Offering unparalleled progressive comfort and reducing transference to other sleepers.

**For more detailed information
follow this link**

**UNDERSTANDING
POCKET SPRINGS**

4. What spring tension do you need?

Once you've chosen the type of spring the next important question is which spring tension to choose? So often people choose a tension that they mistakenly believe will give them the end 'feel' of the mattress.

However, what retailers won't tell you is the spring tension is entirely based on your weight. Based on your weight select the spring tension. Then choose the upholstery to provide the end 'feel' of the mattress. This determines whether the mattress feels soft, medium or firm. If you and your partner are different weights then think about a split tension or zip and link mattress so you can both have a tailored spring tension.



Spring Tension Guide

Spring Tension	Wire Diameter (Gauge)	Weight Range
Soft	1.2 mm	Upto 8 Stone
Medium	1.4 mm	8 - 16 Stone
Firm	1.6 mm	16 Stone Plus
Extra Firm / Orthopaedic	1.9 mm	20 Stone Plus





— BUYING A NEW MATTRESS IS A CONSIDERED PURCHASE AND YOU MAY THINK ALL GUARANTEES ARE CREATED EQUAL BUT SADLY THEY ARE NOT.

5. Check the Guarantee of the mattress and if you can exchange it if it's not suitable.

Firstly lets look at the 'comfort guarantee'

In the event that you find your new mattress unsuitable you may need to exchange it or return it. We offer a no quibble 60 night free of charge exchange or return and cover all the cost. We're ashamed to say this is not the case across the industry - even the most respected names have you so tied up with terms and conditions you may find it impossible or at the least very costly should you

end up with a mattress thats unsuitable. Don't take so called 'comfort guarantees' at face value. Doing a little digging now will save you time and money in the future.

For a full break down of the most popular manufacturers follow this link

**FIND POPULAR
MANUFACTURERS**



Now let's look at the guarantee or warranty.

In most cases you should never need a guarantee unless the mattress is faulty. However, it's important to know you're protected from any failures if they occur. We offer a full repair or replace during our guarantees and collect at our own cost.

Did you know some manufactures will only offer a proportional guarantee / warranty depending on how long you've had the mattress?

Some will charge you for collection or require you to raise the complaint with the original shop you bought it from or expect you to keep the original packaging? Some retailers requirements make the guarantee virtually useless. So make sure you check the fine print. Again this will save you much cost and hassle in the future.



Summary

These hints and tips are by no means exhaustive but should serve as a good starting point when comparing different mattresses.

Our website really does contain everything you should ever need to know about beds. We have a friendly team available to help and guide you should you require any assistance about any of our products even our competitors!

So why not give us a call?

0161 437 4419

John and Ryan



Rated Excellent ★★★★★ Trustpilot

 For free advice call 0161 437 4419